SpeechGeek Presents



Junior, Vol. 2

SpeechGeek

ISSN 1545-9209 Price $25 US
http://www.speechgeek.com

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ISSN 1545-9209

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SpeechGeek is published four times per year: August, October, December, and April by Corey Alderdice, 806 Brownstone Way, Bowling Green, Kentucky 42104. Special issues are published from time to time.

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We're back with a second round of interp scripts that are perfect for middle school competitors.

We have been overwhelmed with the response from coaches across the country who appreciate our efforts to collect scripts for this target audience.

SpeechGeek is proud to publish a wide variety of selections geared for multiple ages, styles, and types and competitors. It's hard to find that "right" script for a new competitor. We're just glad to help.

I hope you enjoy these scripts. If you have ideas for future types of scripts for **SpeechGeek Presents**, please send an email to thegeek@speechgeek.com!

Corey Alderdice
Publisher



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Rose and June

by Bonny McDonald

JUNE. Hey? Well, good morning. Isn't it nice for you kids to visit us old people? Yeah, yeah, it's windy. Eh…Ifyou talk about the weather I'm gonna SMACK yeh. SMACK. (*She laughs conspiratorially*.) Yeah, that's funny, yeah. I'm very funny, alright. Aren't you a nice one. That one who visited me yesterday, she was a pretty one. You're…you're a nice one, yes. Funny little nose, but…nice. What's that? What, dear? WHAT? Well, my feet are just killing me, just KILLING me and my sister's gone crazy, so don't ask me again how I'm doing.

JUNE. Now I have some pictures to show yeah. Mmmmhmm. Now this one—I worked 37 years in the theatre—here we are at the theatre—there's Rose my sister—she's uglier than me, eh? Heh. Ugly. Yes, pretty ugly. An here's me, in my boxy dress. But look, look this one—this is the dress I wore to the school dance. What? Oh, no, I went by myself. Nobody asked me and I was perty sad, but my mother was always sayin', "Life is short, life is short" and I said to here, I said, "I'm not going to dance because nobody asked me!" You see, I was very proud, but that's not any fun, is it? No, so she said, "WELL," she said, "life is short so you might as well go dancing anytime, somebody or nobody asked ya." You might as well! Look at that dress. Just look at it. Red, huh? SEXY! Seeexy. That's me. I went by myself. Pertier than Rose, though nobody asked me. Somebody'd asked Rose. Nice boy. She doesn't remember him now. You've met Rose, right? …Next door to me! She lives right there next door. We've lived here for 30 years, can you believe it? Mr. Howell keeps the rent just as it was then, nice man. Not too bright, is he? But nice. Funny voice, though, but nice…Oh, she's inside, don't like to let her out too much, she's so crazy! But well, let's let her out so she can get a look at you.

JUNE. Rose?!?!?!? Rose, come out and meet our new neighbor…Yes, a college girl. Here we go.
ROSE. A new kitty?
JUNE. Listen to her, a new kitty. NO A NEW NEIGHBOR.
ROSE. Well, hello, I can hardly see you I'm so blind. You know, I'm 93 years old. Mmm hmm, mmm hmm. 93.
JUNE. You wondered why I look so funny, I'm 95!
ROSE. Aren't you a darling. Oh, look, it's Jack rubbin' on me. Hello Mr. Jack. That cat is so bad.
JUNE. She thinks it's Jack—we used to have a cat named Mr. Jack when we was little, we did.

The King of Nerd Camp

by Corey Alderdice

The last thing the campers ask you before their parents forcibly escort them out the dorm door is: "Are you gonna be back next summer?" It's a relatively easy question for a fifteen year old. After all, adolescents aren't bogged down with the prospects of graduation, internships, and getting a real job.

There isn't a lot of time between the moment the question leaves their mouth and hits your ears, so you just answer: "Of course, who else is gonna pay me to hang out for three weeks?"

It could be a lie.

It could be the truth.

Or, it could be somewhere in between.

Usually, it's the kid who asks the question. Today, Harry Chalmer's mom is the first to posit.

"You know, Harry just loves coming to camp." There's a smile on her face as she says this. Harry hasn't turned his head away. He hasn't chastised his mom for embarrassing him in front of the counselor. Instead, he wears the same smile with a sense of pride that won't come back for another forty-eight weeks.

I should actually be one floor up checking out my own campers right now, making sure three weeks worth of dirty laundry and soda cans have found their proper homes. I should be telling the parents of my own campers exactly three good things about each of them. Instead, I'm taking time to talk to the mother of the King of Nerd Camp, an unlikely monarch—Harry Chalmers.

"Harry's a great kid," I say earnestly. "He has the best heart of anyone I know…he's kind…he's considerate…he's a pleasure to have at camp…he's just…*awesome*."

Harry stumbles in his reply partly because of his slight speech impediment and partly because the words catch him off guard. "Oh, well, it's great to have counselors like you." I'm not one hundred percent certain how to take those words. I spend several weeks each summer getting paid to hang out with middle and high schoolers. I make relatively good bank to befriend nerds, to be the fun counselor—a sterling example of a nerd who grew up and became (kind of) cool. But Harry's words this morning are far more rewarding than the paycheck I'll be getting in less than two hours when all of the campers have left.

But the ending needs a beginning to make sense. I work at the Summer Program for Verbally and Mathematically Precocious Youth That's a mouthful to say in casual conversation and usually garners a slightly confused look from your audience. That's why the director shortened it to VAMPY. However, VAMPY gets the same look. There's really only one name that makes sense of it all.

Nerd camp.

*

I've waited over three hundred days for this moment to return, to have the opportunity to be fifteen again. Fifteen minus the bad haircut and acne. Fifteen with benefits. You see, summer camp is the quintessential part of any childhood experi-

ence. Some kids went to basketball camp while others spent weeks on end learning about Jesus. Chunky kids went to fat camp and me, well, I now go to the camp where kids learn about quantum mechanics and papier-mâché.

At fifteen, though, the people who go to VAMPY are simply Nerds. Funny little word *nerd*. Dictionaries can be as cruel and calloused as the nerd's social peers, defining the nerd as: *a foolish, inept, or unattractive person; a person who is single-minded or accomplished in scientific or technical pursuits but is felt to be socially inept.*

The job description I answered three years ago could have said these exact words and I still would have signed up for the job.

I want the paycheck. I won't lie about that, but I also want to be the kind of kid that I wish I could have been at thirteen. I want to have fun, to talk to other people, to feel accepted, but I cannot be that kid again. I can be a twenty-one year old adult who acts fifteen, but I can't be that for real. I *can* help other kids throw off their awkwardness. I *can* be so goofy and geeky that they don't feel odd. I *can* do everything in my power to make this the best summer ever.

But there's always one kid who needs our help more than the others, a kid who is so socially inept that it's almost like a superpower. Quieter than a fish…more introverted than a headless turtle…unable to hold eye contact for more than two seconds…the SOCIALLY AWKWARD AVENGER! (Cue the theme music.) That was Harry Chalmers. It wasn't hard to pick out Harry, even among the throng of several hundred nerds. He was the kid with the high socks and low self-confidence. Yet one day, we saw a flash of brilliance in this kid, and that's when the counselors knew we could make Harry the King of Nerd Camp.

Harry Chalmers assumed the throne of Nerddom with a little help from his loyal subjects. He began his rise to power on the battlefield, fighting bravely with dodgeball in hand. He knew no fear, hurling the spheres against his foes— never relenting or surrendering to his opposition. Because of this determination, he walked away victorious. The legend began.

Harry Chalmers is the kind of kid you root for—the underdog with a heart of gold. He's Rocky Balboa without the bruised face. He's that jockey who rode Seabiscut, minus the horse. He's Rudy…only not Irish-Catholic…He's...well…he's just the kind of nerd who you surmise lives on the fringe of the social spectrum back in the "real world" and, sadly, remains on the edge even in the opportunity that is nerd camp. Most kids use camp as the opportunity to reinvent themselves. After all, the campers understand what it's like to be the academic outsider who's the smartest person in all of their classes.

When put together, though, thinking is cool.

Asking questions is totally awesome.

Learning is the most productive activity one can participate in.

Just by looking at Harry Chalmers, you knew he belonged at nerd camp. His almost six foot frame was overly awkward even for a high schooler. His wiry limbs were still slightly confused about how to move, yet there was his smile. It was almost

eerie and only eerie in that it was so sincere.

Maybe that's why the counselors saw something special in Harry Chalmers.

*

Nerd camp follows a very regimented schedule. Breakfast. Meeting. Sleep. Lunch. Sleep. Meeting. Dinner. Activities. Hang out. Sleep. Repeat for three whole weeks (including Saturday and Sunday).

When mealtime comes around once more, I keep an eye out for Harry. He walks past the group of counselors on his way into the cafeteria, avoiding eye contact with each of us. Harry slowly files his way around the lines and sits down at a two-seat table next to the window for a quiet and peaceful lunch. He is alone for all of fifteen seconds before I sit down.

"Hiya, Harry." I say. "How're things going today?"

"Oh, oh, they're good. Class is good."

"Do you mind if I sit down."

"Yeah, yeah, sure. Thanks."

Harry and I talk for twenty minutes. I sip at my glass of soda while he eats his lunch. We don't talk about anything of great significance, just regular small talk. As we're talking, though, I realize just how genuine this kid is. It's not that Harry doesn't want to be around people, he's just didn't know what to say. He just needs to be included. He just needs a chance.

I promised myself at lunch that day that I'd give him that chance.

The one common part of the chain is the endless string of meetings. Each morning the counselors will gather in a small room in the university center. It was behind these walls, that the fate of the nerds was decided. That afternoon, we created the legend.

"You know what?" A rhetorical question such as this always gets the obligatory "what?" in return. Counselor Zane obliges. "I want Harry Chalmers to become the king of nerd camp."

"You mean the King of Dodgeball, Harry Chalmers?"

"Yeah, why not?"

"I don't know, isn't he, well, shy?" I don't think Zane's buying into my master plan. After all, counselors have a lot of power over the nerds in our charge, but we can't control them. "Just how do you plan on doing this?"

"We just tell everyone how cool Harry is. People will catch on sooner or later."

"I'll play your little game," Zane replies with the enthusiasm of a Bond villain. "When do we start?"

"How about at dinner?"

As we walk to dinner that night, I stop Harry. I inform him that he will be eating dinner with Zane and me and that we will be working the crowd, pressing some flesh, meeting and greeting. This seems to confuse Harry, as dinner is generally the time for eating. King's Rule Number One: In order to be king, you have to have loyal subjects. Zane and I move from table to table, getting to know the kids ourselves and introducing Harry along the way. He extends an awkward hand and smiles. Most of the campers seem genuinely interested in meeting the future King. Harry fumbles for the right words to say, and when in doubt Zane and I step in to fill

the verbal gaps. By the end of dinner, we have worked eighty-percent of the room.

*

By the next Monday, we had established Harry Chalmers as a house-hold, or dorm-room, name. Everyone knew who the tall, awkward kid was. Yet they looked past what some would call his deficiencies and saw a really great guy. Some kids did it to simply impress the counselors. Others did it because they truly liked Harry. For Zane and me, it had become a bit of an obsession. To solidify his kingship, we needed to take this whole scheme to a new level. The question is when would we have the attention of the entire camp? The talent show.

It made total sense.

The ultimate status symbol of nerd camp is being selected as one of four emcees for the talent show. Students compete for the title and take the job very seriously. The choice rests in the hands of the counselors. Now, one might say this is unfair seeing as all the counselors by now had such a Harry Chalmers complex. This was a justified abuse of power.

Being an emcee is a big honor. And we want to pick students who are not only outgoing, but also good role models. Five minutes later, Harry Chalmers was the first unanimously elected emcee during my nerd camp tenure. The eight hours from the meeting until we told Harry the good news seemed like an eternity. We crafted several ways of telling him, yet decided a straightforward approach would be the best idea. As he walked by Zane and me sitting under the shade tree I shouted, "Harry, pull up some grass."

He stopped and sat down his overstuffed backpack. "What's up guys?"

"You're an emcee!" I couldn't hold the news in. Sometimes the easiest way to say something is the best and only way to do it.

"Really, well…uh, I'm not really sure if I want to do it." My heart sank. How could Harry pass up an opportunity like this? "I'm afraid I won't be any good at it."

He needed reassurance. "You're Harry-Freakin'-Chalmers, King of Freakin' Nerd Camp. You'll be awesome."

"Can I think about it?" Sure he can think about it, but he'll come around. At least I think he'll come around.

"Talk to us after dinner, okay?" This wasn't the response we anticipated. After two full weeks of work this was supposed to be the pinnacle of the Harry Chalmers experience, but it could fall apart with one word.

No.

Thank goodness that wasn't the final answer.

He sought us out at the end of dinner. Harry spoke with reluctance, but there was that trademark smile of his that convince me. "If you guys think that I can do it, then I will." I breathed a sigh of relief. That was going to be Harry's moment to shine, a chance for him to really come out of his shell. We, well, I was going to make the most of this opportunity. For the next three days we wrote jokes and concocted skits based around Harry Chalmers. The other three emcees: a cool guy, a female 24, and a sporty gal made up the rest of the team. They were more than excited to play into the whole Harry Chalmers theme. It was time to go public with the King of Nerd Camp.

*

When the curtain rose on Thursday night, Harry was carried to the stage by a group of four male counselors. Crowned with a Burger King cardboard hat and draped in a moldy green bathrobe, the procession moved toward the stage as I heralded the arrival of the King of Nerd Camp. He pronounced from the top of the stage, "Only I can set you fwee." Who cares if Harry wasn't very good at

enunciating the hard "r" sound? Everyone loved it.

The skit was a story of star-crossed lovers. He saved the beautiful Chloe from being bombarded with dodgeballs at the hands of counselors. Yet Chloe was tempted by dark forces and decided to betray the noble King Chalmers. In the final scene she reached from behind a bush to pull out a dodgeball. In an instant, the sphere struck Harry in the face. The king was no more. His dying words,

"*Et tu*, Chloe?"

The crowd erupted. Our plan was successful. After the show, we had a small autograph signing to celebrate the evening. Zane had spent the afternoon at the Walgreen's one-hour photo getting copies of Harry Chalmers' photo. Harry politely sat behind the desk with Sharpie in hand, scribbling out messages to his devoted fans. Yet the smile on his face that evening was no different than the smile when I sat down with him for lunch the first Monday of camp. It wasn't important that everyone knew who he was. It mattered that they were having a good time at camp.

So why did I do it? For two weeks each summer I get to be the kind of kid I wish I would have been at thirteen. Harry Chalmers got to be the kind of kid I wish I was at fifteen. And you will likely question: is this selfish of me?

I'm talking to Harry's mom on Saturday morning as she's packing up Harry's suitcase. I say the wonderful things about her kid: "Harry's a great kid. He has the best heart of anyone I know…he's kind…he's considerate…he's a pleasure to have at camp…he's just…*awesome*."

But I don't stop there. "Harry reminds me why I do this job. He helps me to remember there's more to life than being cool. The best thing you can be is a good person. You're lucky to have such a fine son."

It's a bit saccharine, straight from the Hallmark Hall of Fame, but I can't help myself in this moment. I wonder is if she wonders how Harry has adjusted to being by himself these last three weeks. I wonder if he'll tell her all the stories or if he'll keep them to himself.

That's his decision, not mine, and there's always next summer to find out.